

from the command prompt. Rename the apk file to zip file and open it. Copy the META-INF folder and AndroidManifest.xml folder and replace it in the build folder of the newly compiled folder. Build it again from the command prompt and you will have the new apk file in the dist folder.

Updater-Script and update-binary- How a ROM is installed

So how does a phone actually flash a ROM to the device. This is where the updater-script and update-binary files located in the META-INF/com/google/android folder comes into picture.

When you select the ROM zip in your recovery software like TWRP, the software looks for the update-binary file and understands whether the zip has to be installed with a Standalone Installer or Aroma Installer. If it's standalone installer, then it looks for the updater-script file which is located in the same folder (it has to be) which tell the recovery software what to do with the zip file.

If you want to understand the syntax of the updater-script file, read on.

- `ui_print("")`

This one is simple. It simply tells the simple to print whatever text is present in the double quotes.

- `run_program("/sbin/busybox","mount","/system")`

This command mounts the "system" partition of the device. Mounting is required so that you can add or remove files from the partition. This was just an example of the run_program command line. ROM building requires that data, cache and dalvik are also mounted. So you will always see the following set of code in the beginning of any updater-script of a ROM

- `run_program("/sbin/busybox","mount","/system");`
- `run_program("/sbin/busybox","mount","/data");`
- `run_program("/sbin/busybox","mount","/cache");`
- `run_program("/sbin/busybox","mount","/preload");`

- `delete("/file_path")`

It deletes the file located at the path which is specified in the parenthesis.

- `delete_recursive("/directory")`